

Positioning Blocks on the Page



Lesson Plan

1

Document Flow

2

Positioning in the Flow

document flow

– is an abstract model of how elements on a webpage are arranged and interact with each other. It determines the order in which elements will be displayed on the page.

- The standard flow runs **from left to right, top to bottom**.
The flow is maintained in any element.
- The flow consists of two types of elements:
 - **inline**
 - **block**

Content

block-level boxes – Occupy the entire available horizontal width and start on a new line

display: block, list-item, table, flex, grid

<h1>-<h6>	<nav>	<main>	<header>
<div>	<section>	<form>	<footer>
<p>	<article>	/	<aside>

inline-level boxes – Occupy only the necessary horizontal space and are placed on the same line. They don't start on a new line and take up only as much space as they need.

display: inline, inline-block, inline-table, inline-flex, inline-grid

<a>	<label>	<select>	<button>
	<textarea>	<input>	

document flow

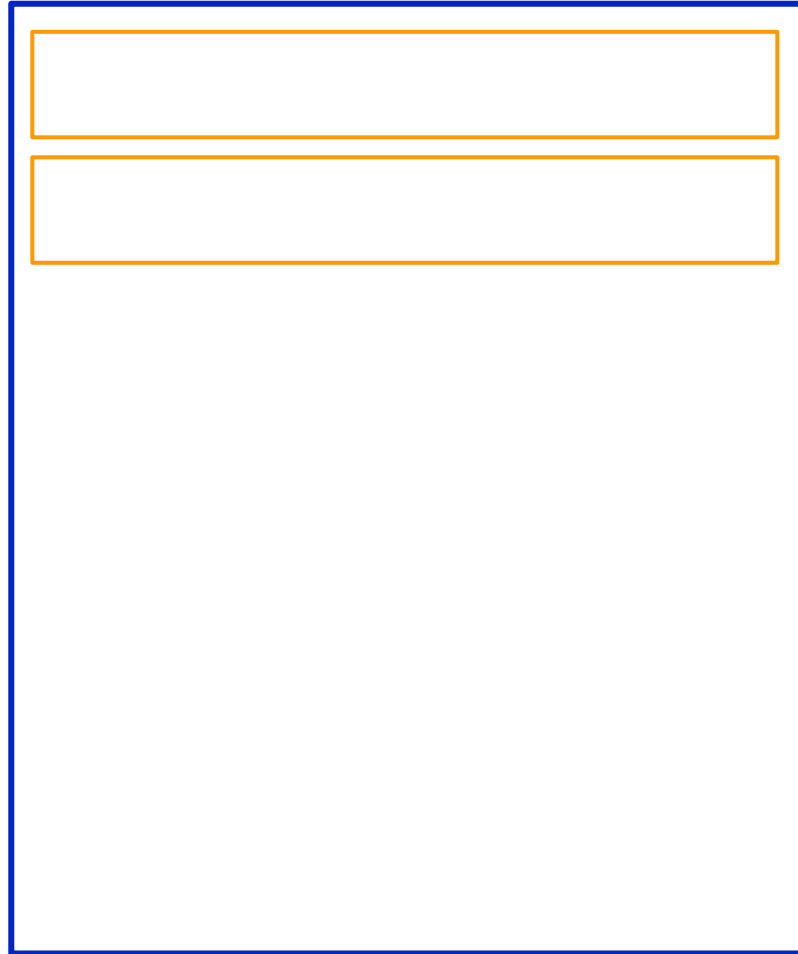
Normal flow



block element

document flow

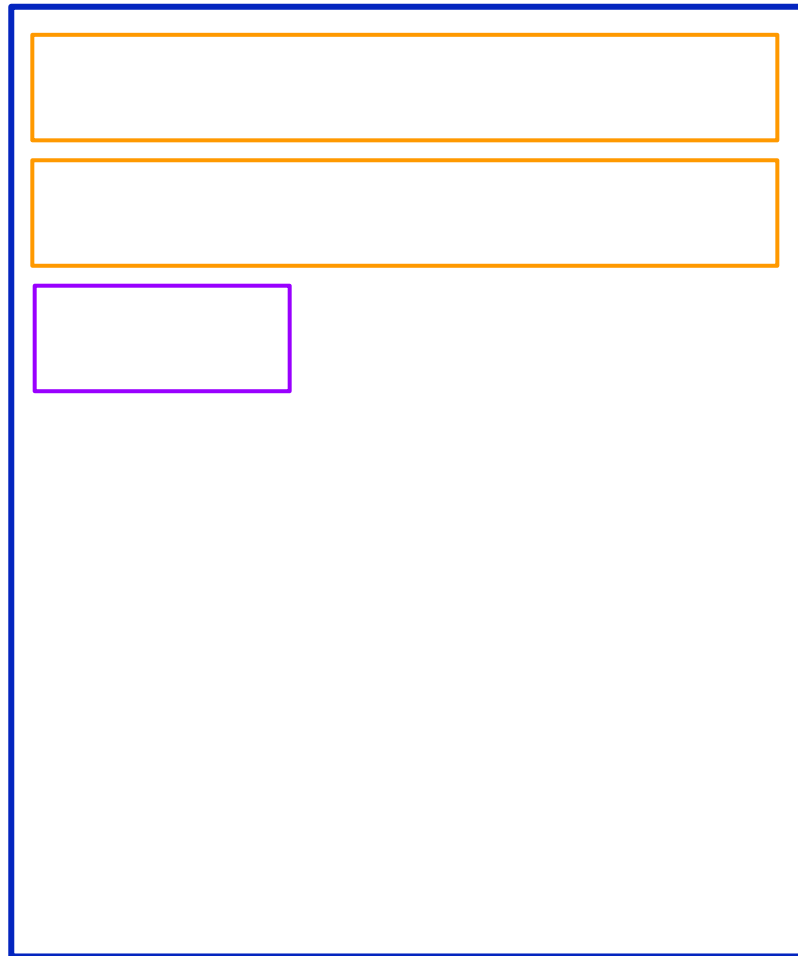
Normal flow



block element

document flow

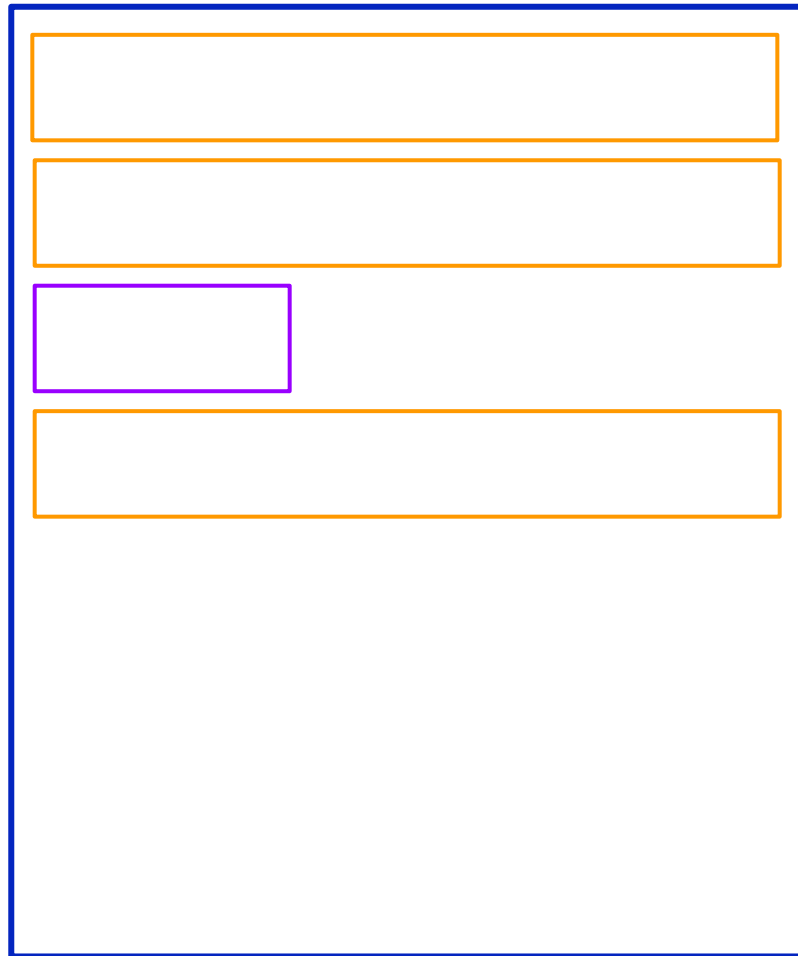
Normal flow



inline element

document flow

Normal flow

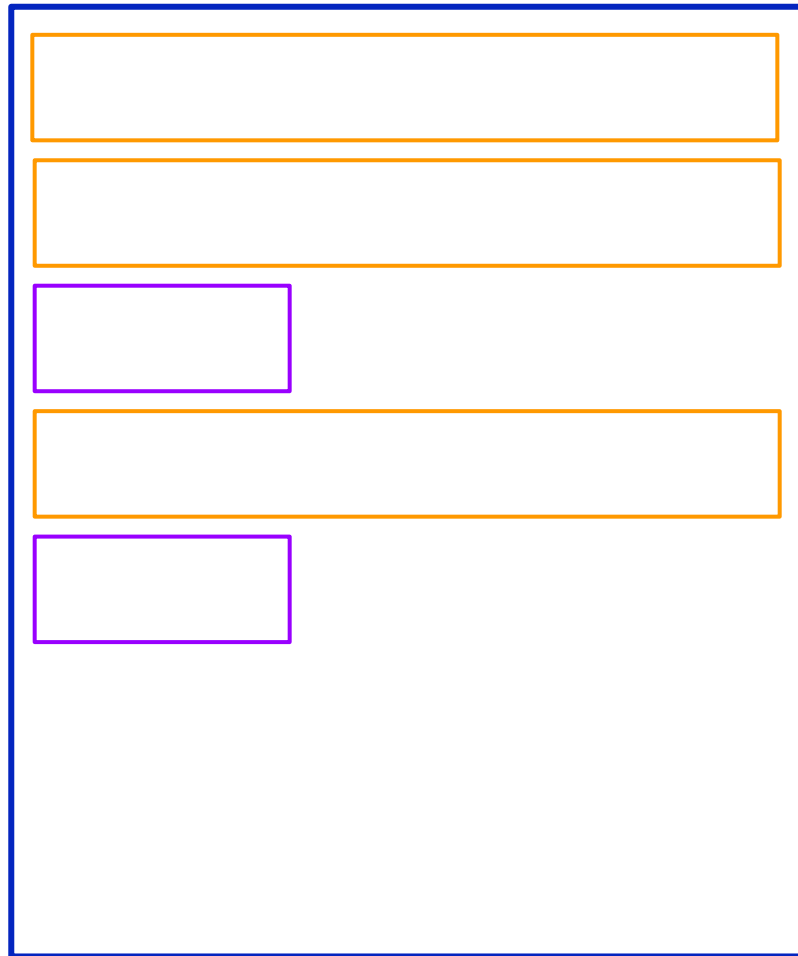


inline element

block element

document flow

Normal flow



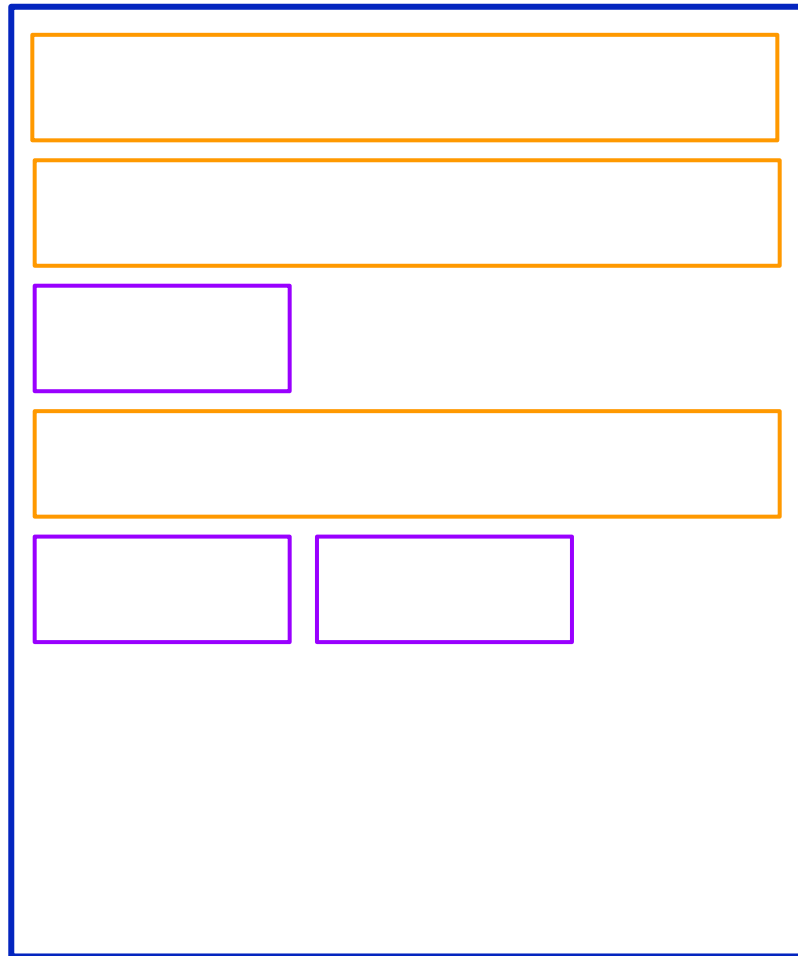
inline element

block element

inline element

document flow

Normal flow

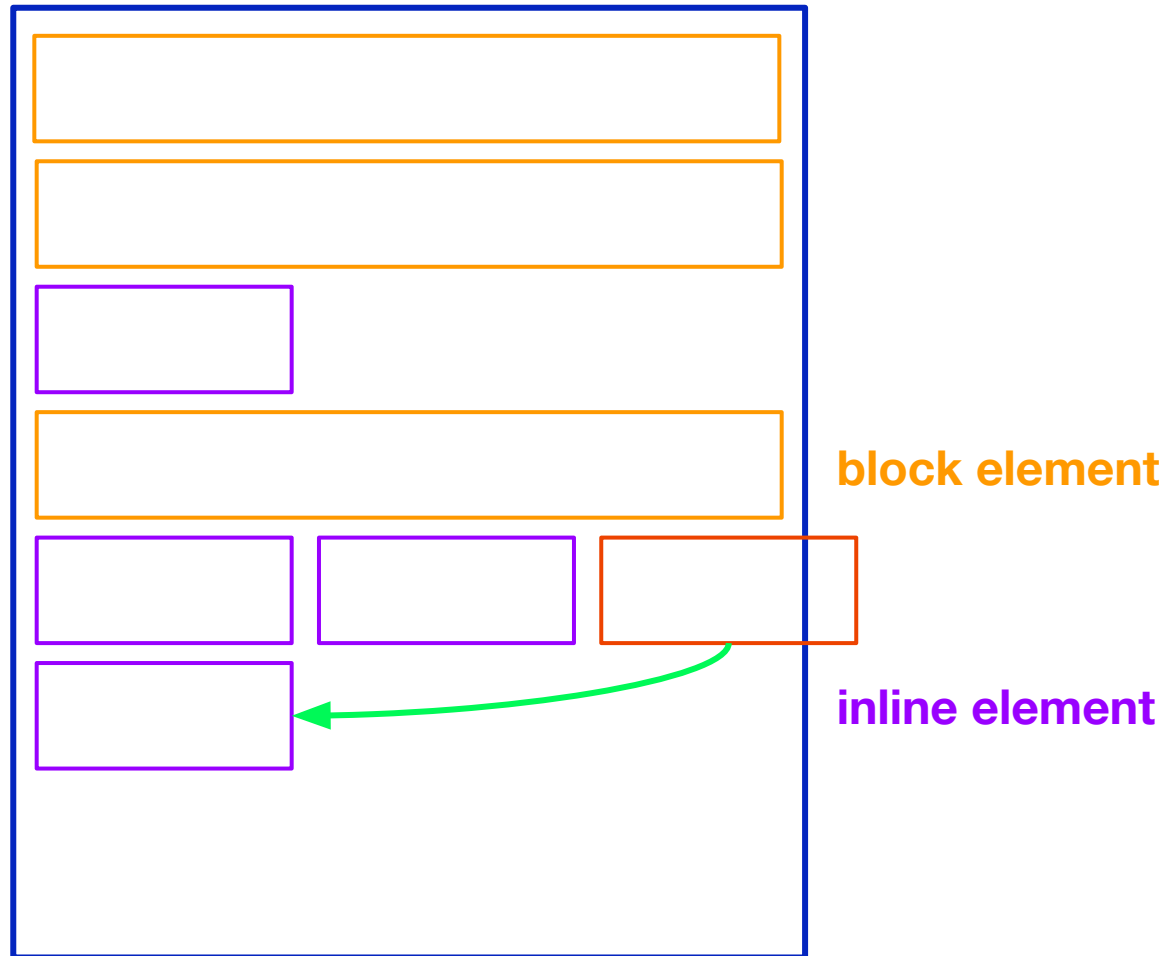


block element

inline element

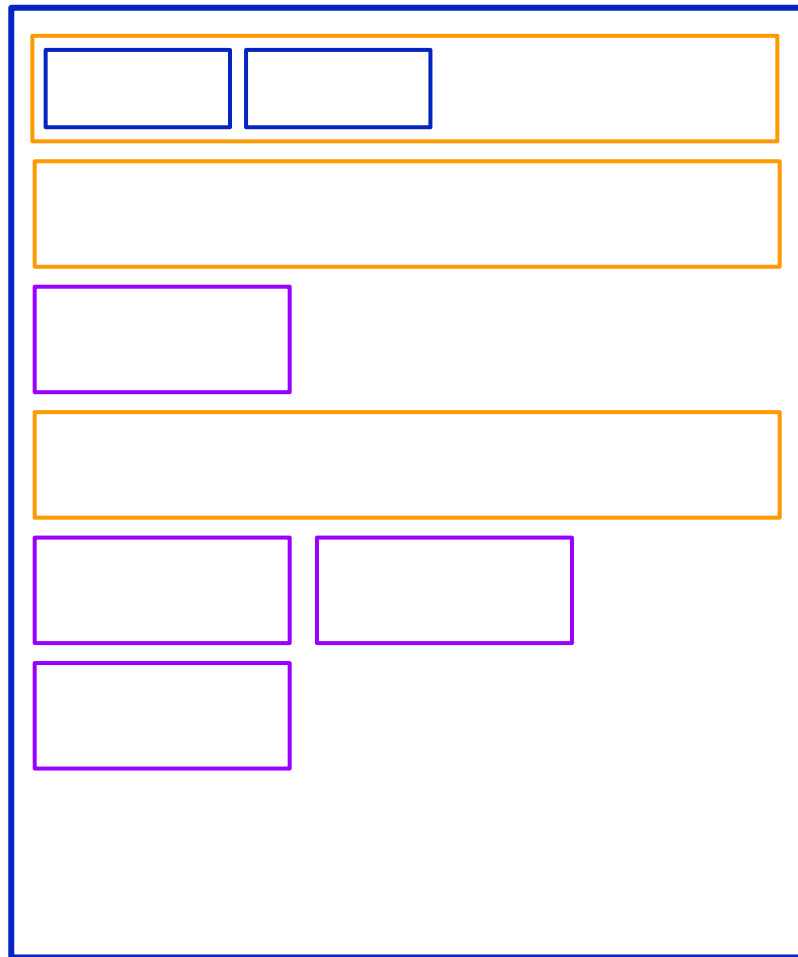
document flow

Normal flow



document flow

Normal flow

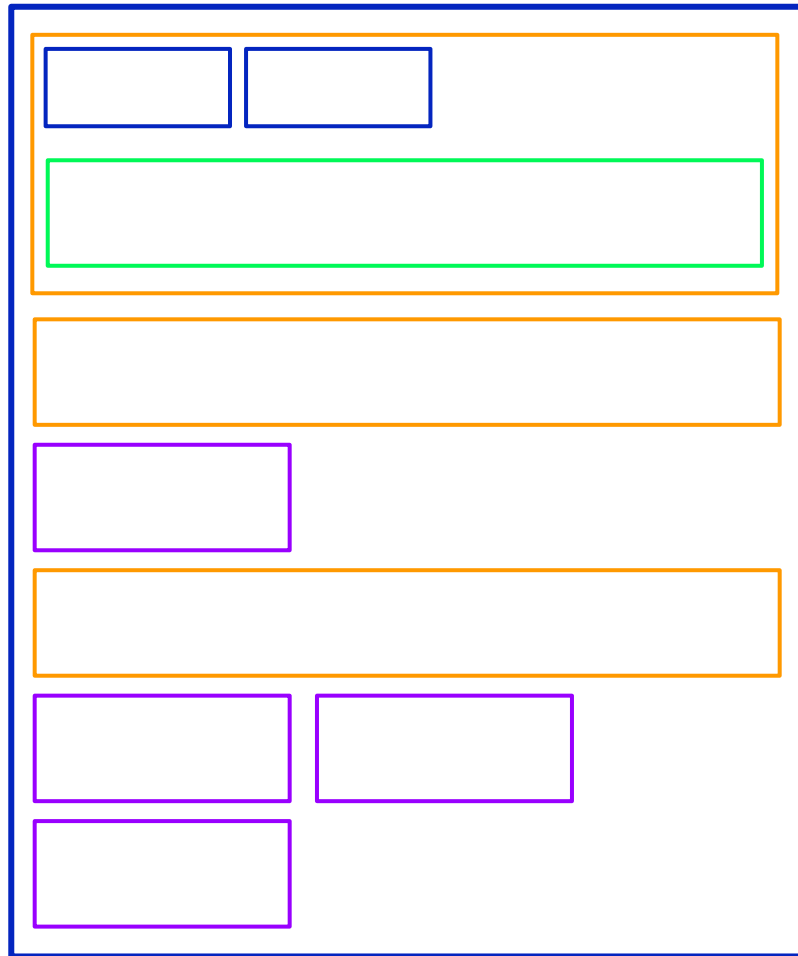


inline elements

in block element

document flow

Normal flow



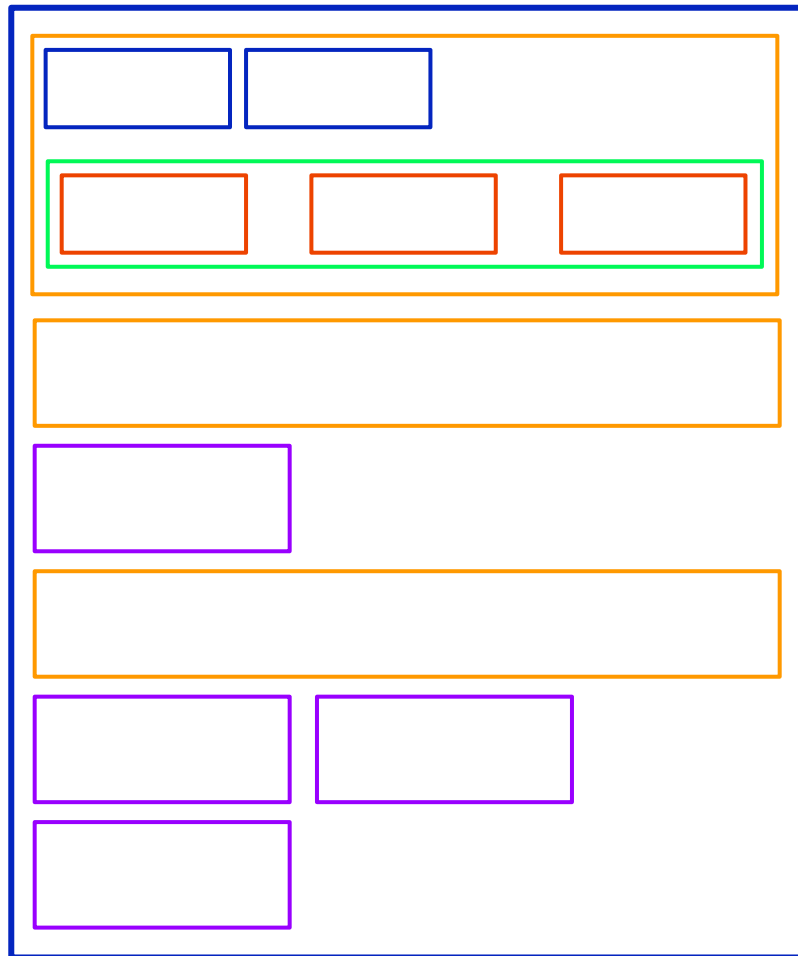
inline elements

block element

in block element

document flow

Normal flow



inline elements

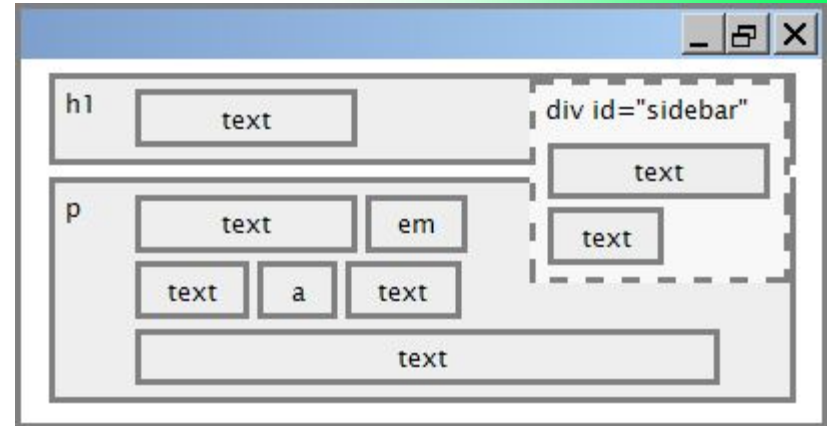
inline elements

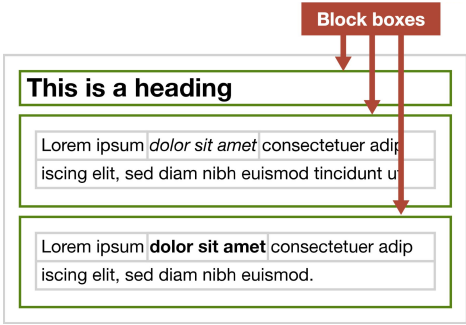
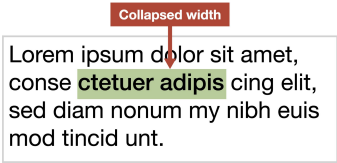
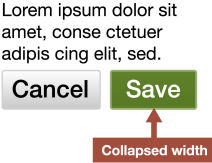
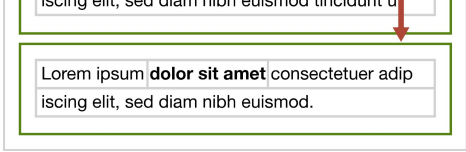
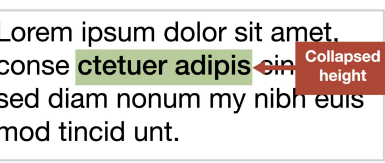
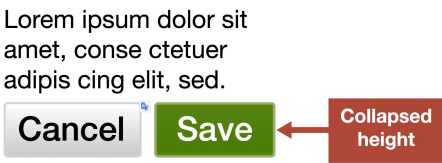
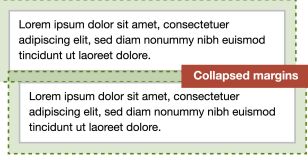
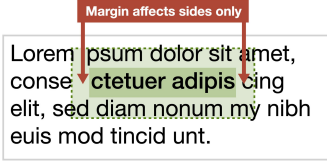
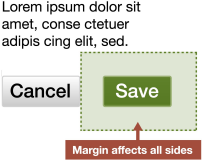
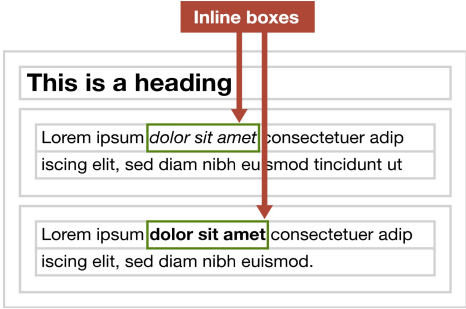
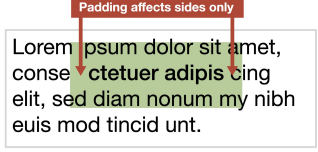
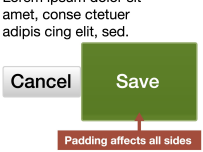
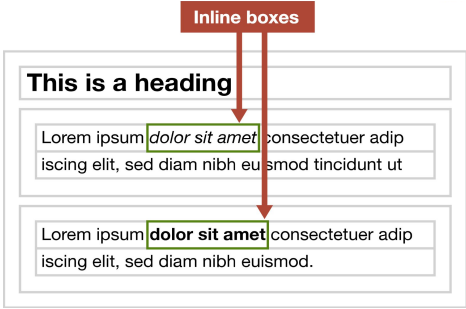
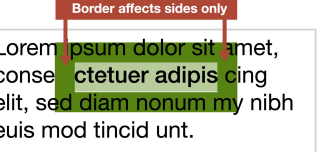
in block element

in block element

Properties Affecting Document Flow

- display
- width, height
- position
- float
- gap, column-gap, row-gap
- margin, padding, border



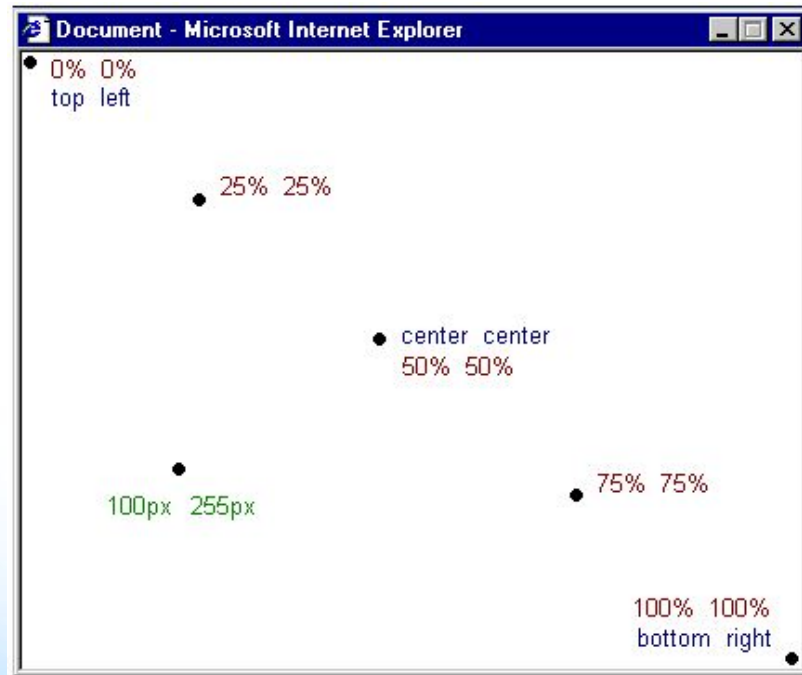
	block boxes	inline boxes	inline-block boxes
Default width			
Default height			
Margins			
Padding			
Border			

The **position** property specifies the type of positioning method used for an element:

Positioning should not be used for creating layouts, only for decorative purposes

CSS POSITION

- **Do not use margin** to set the position of such an element.
- Units of measurement:
 - px
 - %
 - **top, right, bottom, left** (can be negative.)
 - **inset** – shorthand property for **top, right, bottom, left**
- should **always** have at least **one horizontal and one vertical** coordinate specified
- You can specify all four coordinates simultaneously, but there's no guarantee that they will all work together as expected.

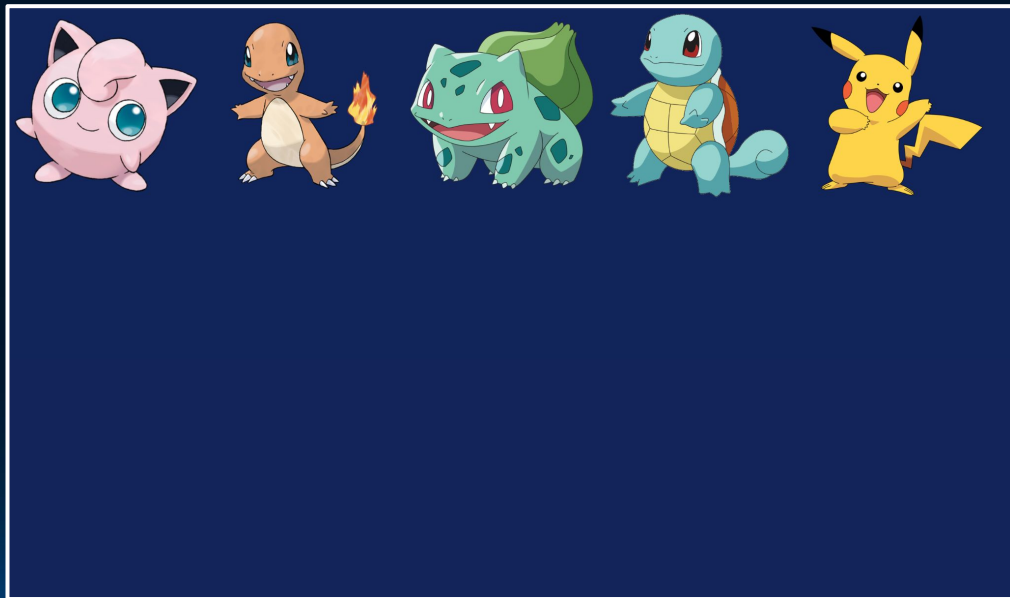


CSS COORDINATE SYSTEM

position:

static 

- default value for all elements
- Elements take their place in the flow depending on the box type and the amount of content.
- **top, right, bottom, left, z-index** don't work
- **normal document flow**



```
position: static;
```

position:

relative 

- The element **remains in the normal document flow**.
- It is positioned relative to its **original position in the flow**.
- Space for the element is **still reserved** in the document flow.
- normal document flow



```
position: relative;  
left: 20px;  
top: 20px;
```

position:

absolute 

- The element is **removed from the document flow**, and neighboring elements completely **ignore it**.
- It is positioned **relative to its parent block**
or
the nearest ancestor with **position: relative**.
- If both horizontal or both vertical coordinates are specified, the element will stretch between them.



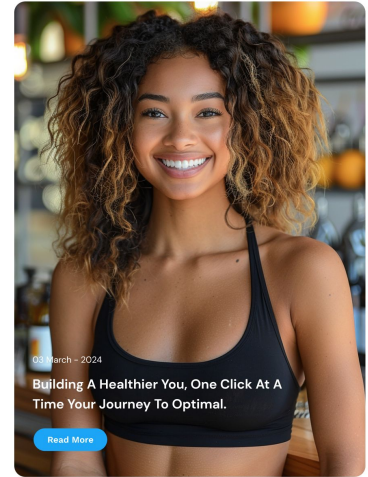
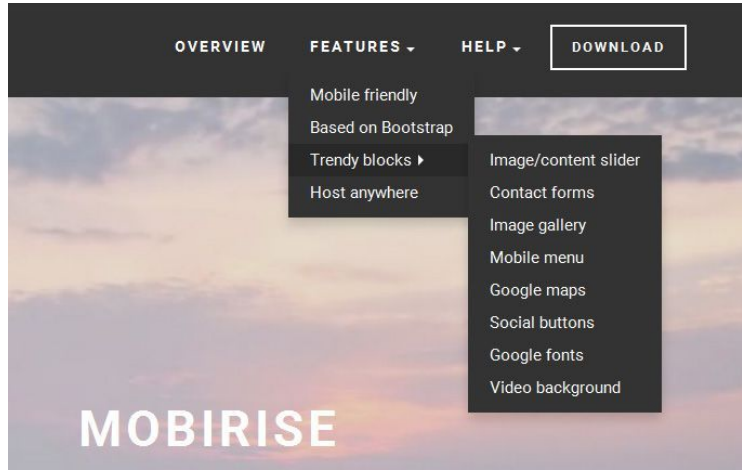
```
position: absolute;  
left: 0;  
top: 10px;
```



Phitaya

\$10.00

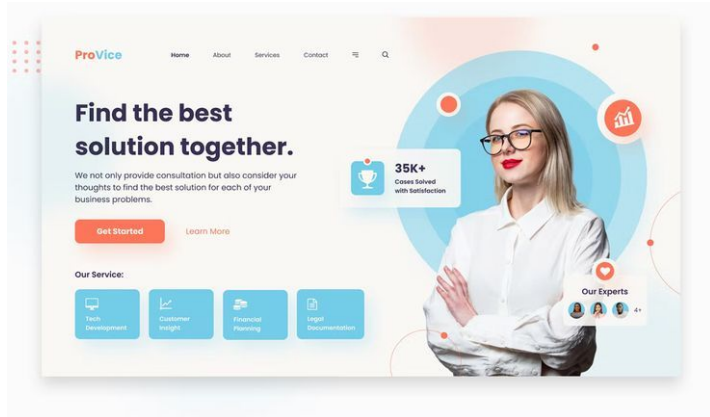
Handwritten Font • Fonts



01 March - 2024

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position:

fixed 

- The element is removed from the document flow, and neighboring elements completely ignore it.
- It is positioned relative to the **viewport**.
- It does not move when **the page is scrolled**.
- If both horizontal or both vertical coordinates are specified, the element will stretch between them.

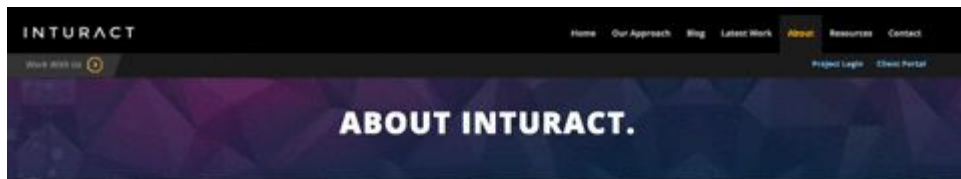
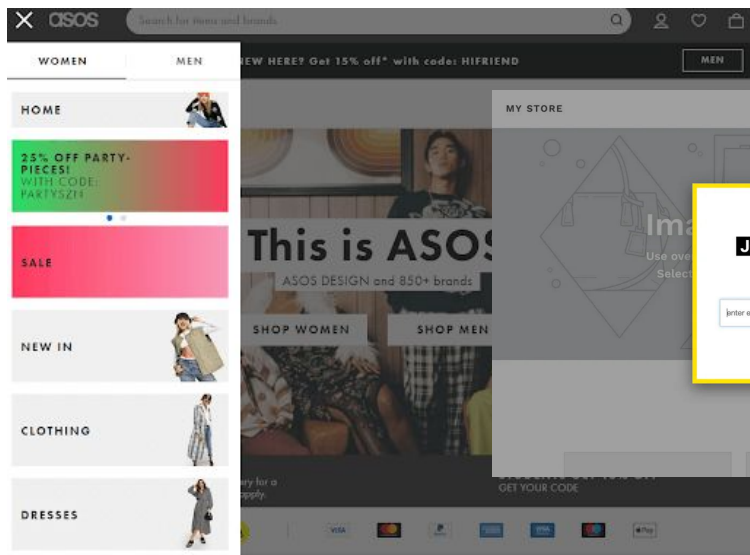


```
position: fixed;  
left: 20px;  
top: 20px;
```


Fixed Mobile Sticky Menu

Use HTML and CSS to create a cross browser mobile navigation that sticks

By: John McGarrah



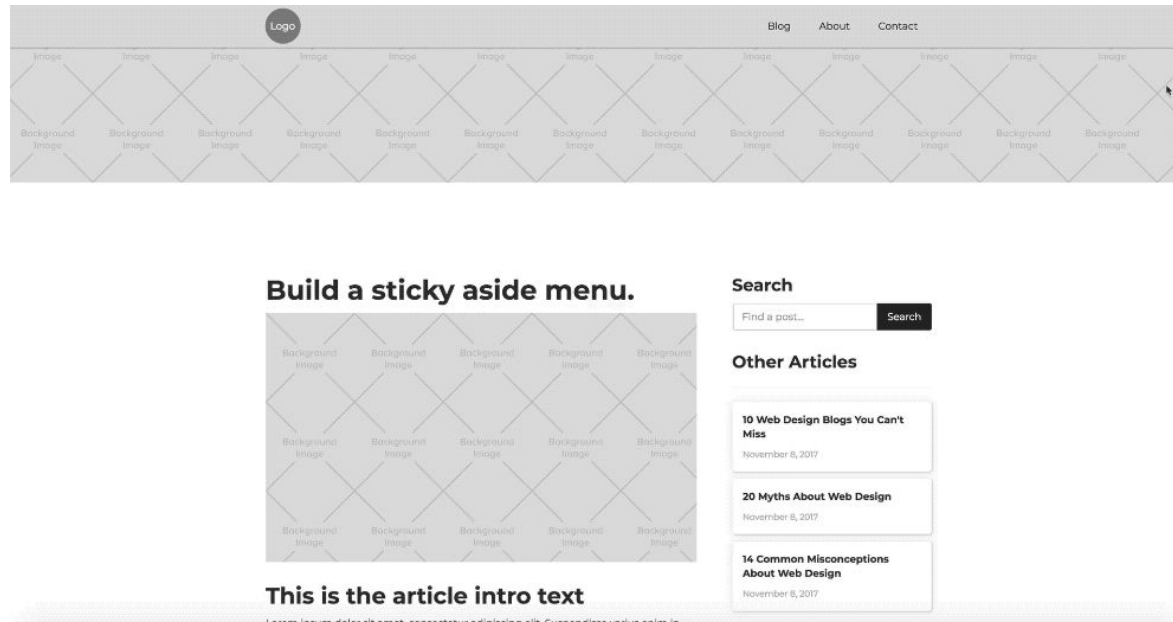
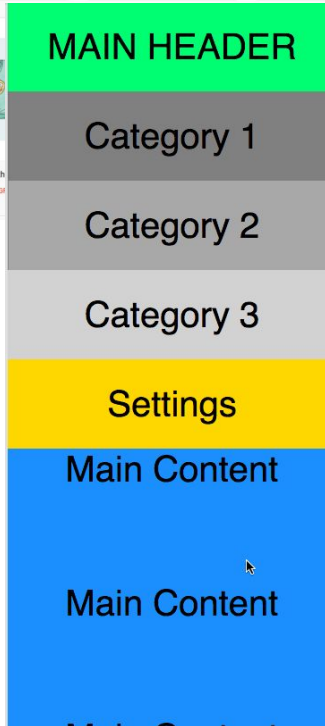
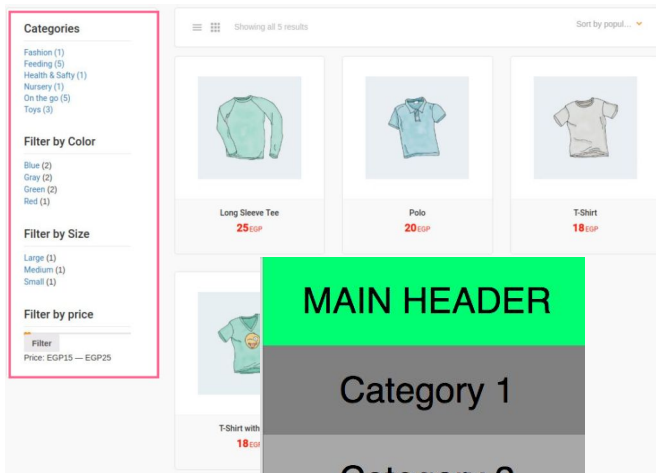
position:

sticky 

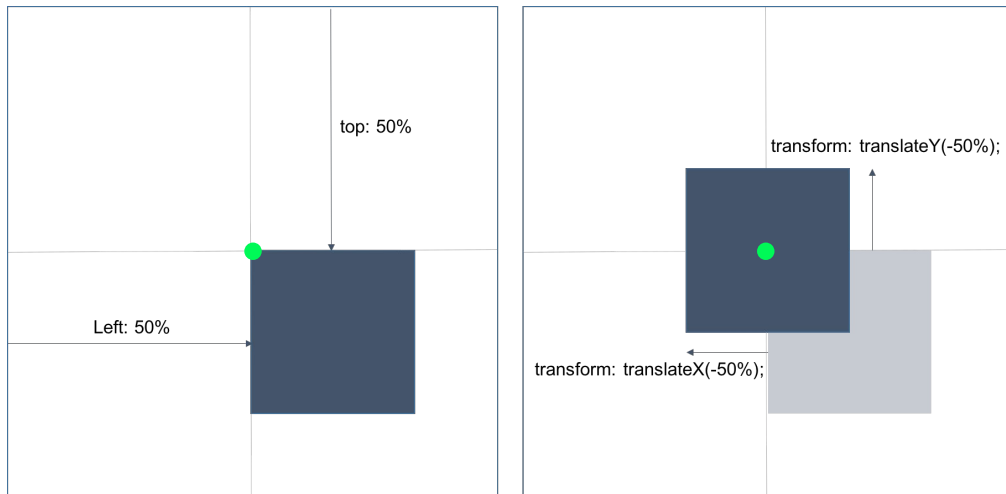
- The element is removed from the document flow.
- Neighboring elements behave as if the element is still in its original position, and space for the element is **still reserved** in the document flow.
- The element does not move when its containing **block is scrolled**.
- It behaves like **position: relative** until the block is scrolled, after which it behaves like **position: fixed**



```
position: sticky;  
right: 0;  
top: 10px;
```



center position



Demo

Adds an offset upward by half the height of the block:

transform:
translateY(-50%);

Adds an offset to the left by half the width of the block:

transform:
translateX(-50%);

or

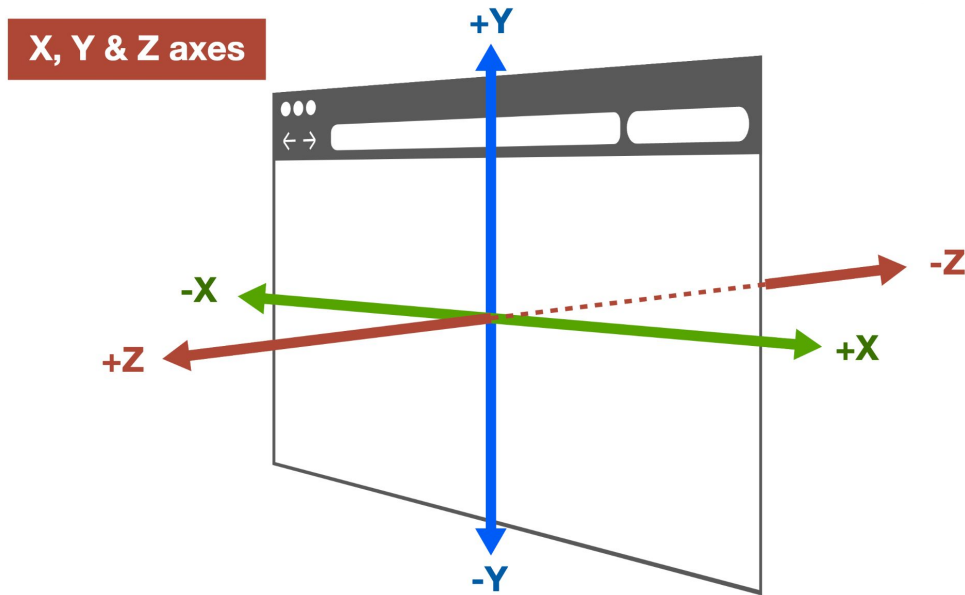
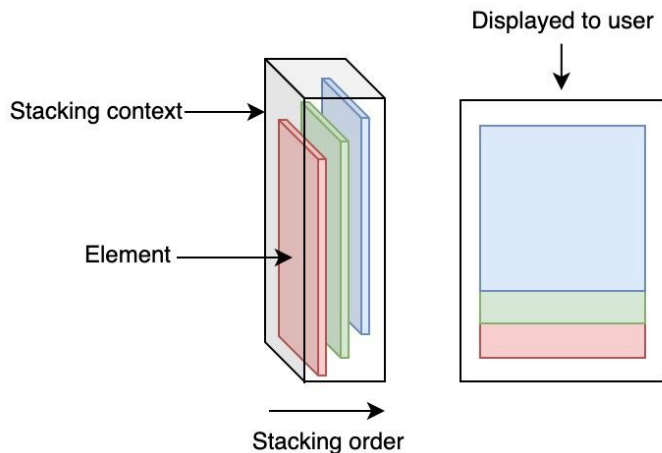
translate: -50%
-50%;

stacking context

x - left / right

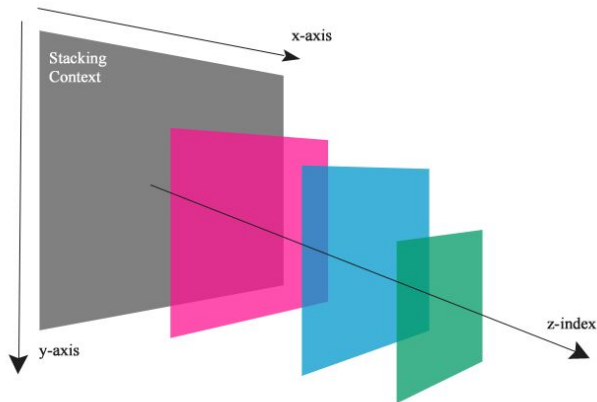
y - top / bottom

z - z-index



z-index

Demo

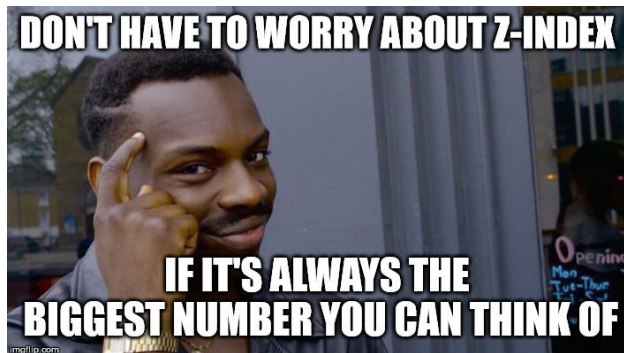


- Controls the stacking order of elements within a stacking context.
- Applies only to elements with an explicitly defined `position` other than `static`.
- If positioning is not needed but you still require a z-index, use `position: relative` without coordinates.
- Values can be positive or negative numbers.
- The higher the number, the more visible the layer.
- By default, `z-index: auto` is used, and visibility is determined by the element's position in the DOM tree: the lower it is in the code, the more visible it is.

z-index

- Stacking context determines the order of how elements are layered on top of each other

Z-index should start from 1 and increment by +1 to avoid using random large numbers like 10, 83, 100, etc.



You've come this far, no going back now.



Z-Index:
1000000000000

Real World CSS

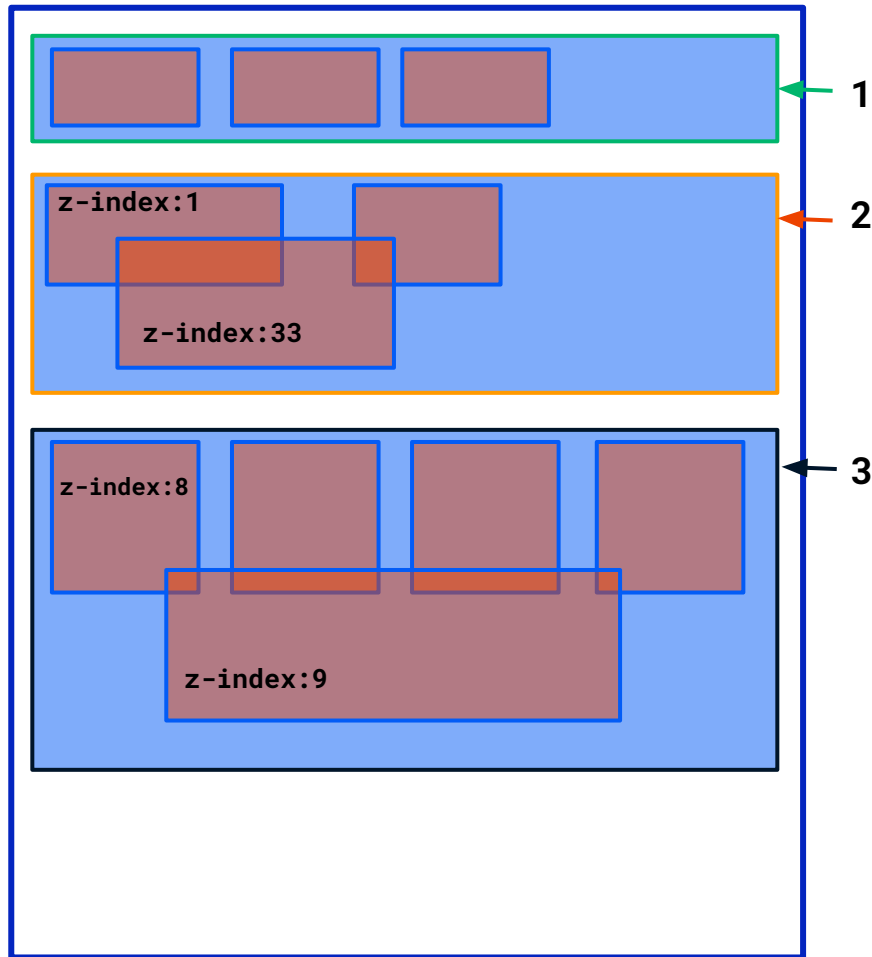
O RLY?

@ThePracticalDev

stacking

context

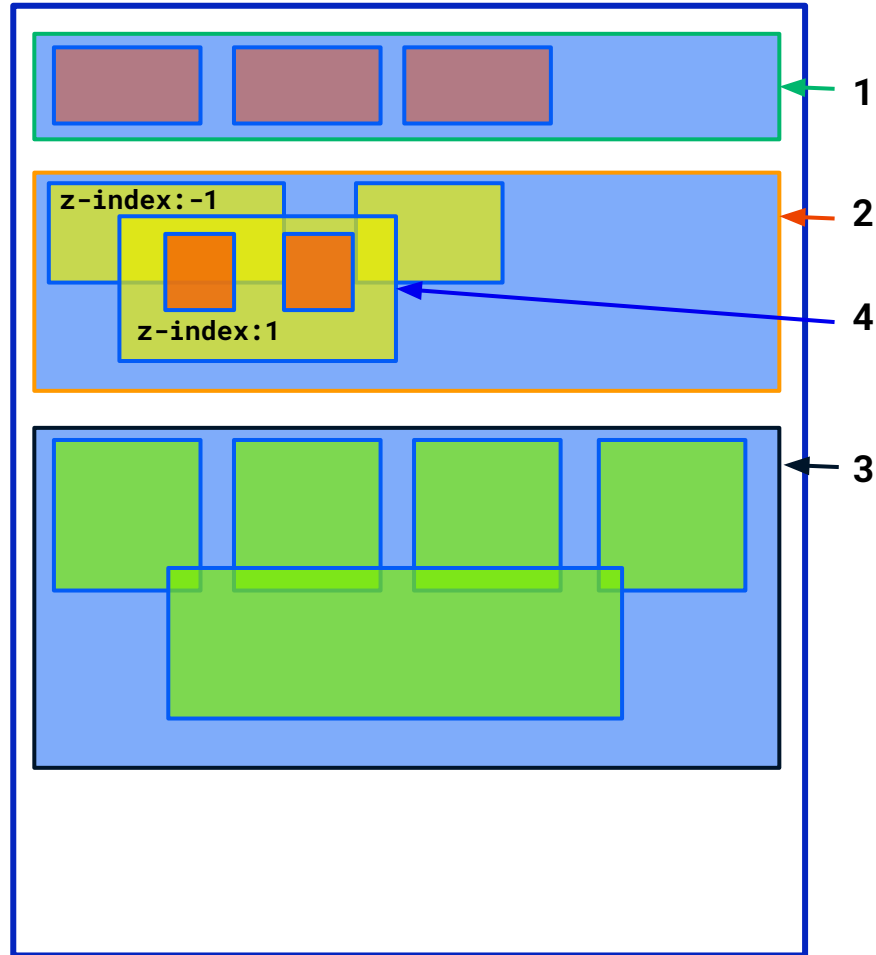
- There can be multiple independent stacking contexts on a page.
- **z-index** property applies to child elements within an element that creates a stacking context.



stacking 

context

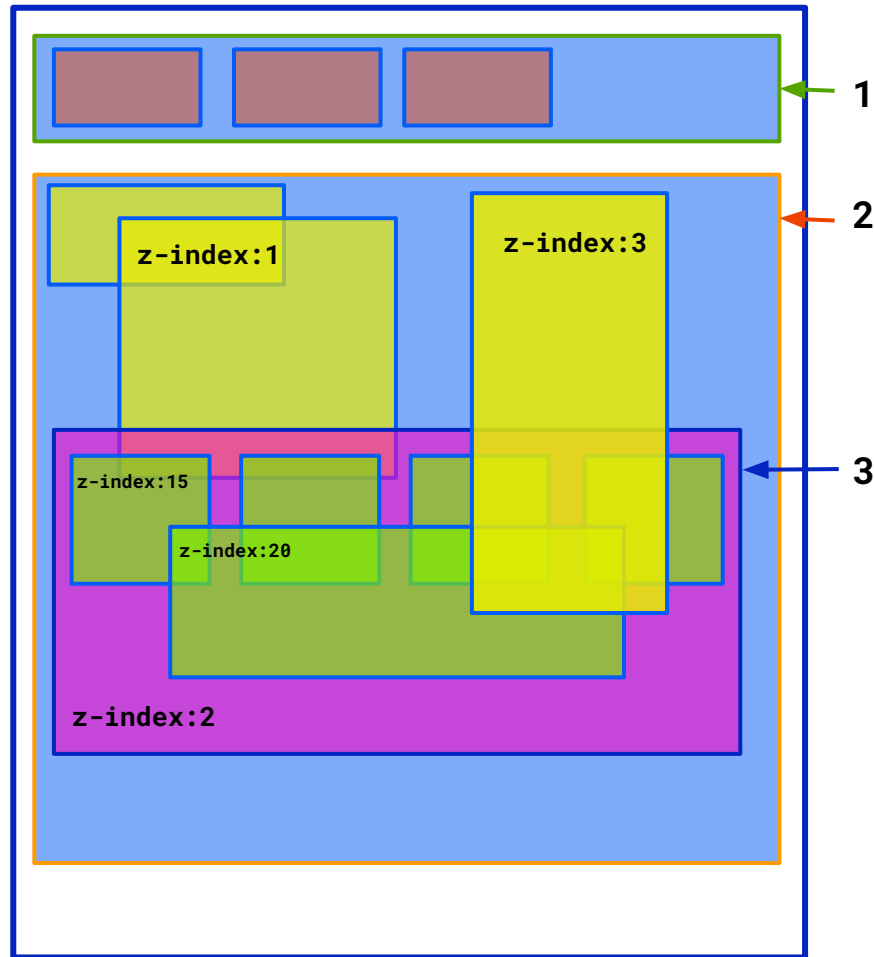
Elements that are direct descendants of the same parent belong to the same stacking context.



stacking

context

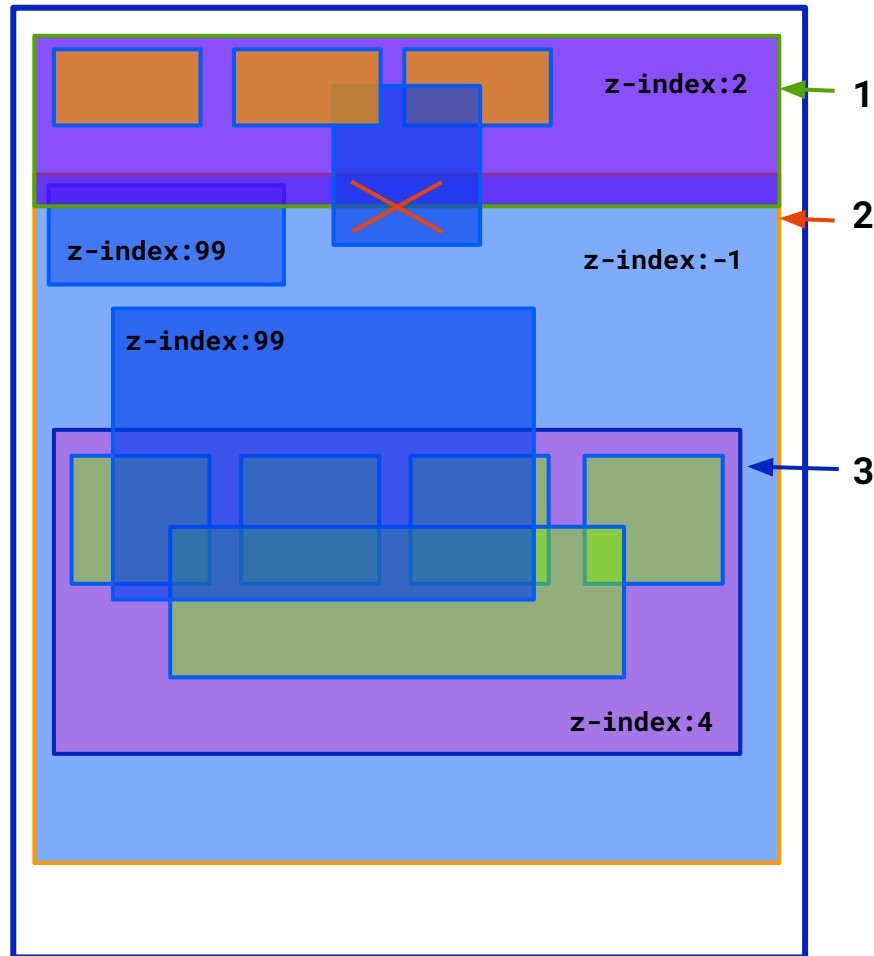
- One stacking context can be nested within another.
- Child elements are considered part of their parent's stacking context.



stacking 

context

Elements within one stacking context cannot be positioned between elements of another stacking context.



stacking context

root stacking context – `<html>` tag creates the root stacking context, unless other conditions are specified:

- **position: absolute** with a **z-index** other than **auto**
- **position: relative** with a **z-index** other than **auto**
- **position: fixed**
- **position: sticky** (only on mobile devices)
- A child element of a **flex** container with a **z-index** other than **auto**
- **opacity** less than 1
- **transform** with a value other than **none**
- **filter** with a value other than **none**
- **perspective** with a value other than **none** or 0

❌ Don't apply these to BEM blocks:

Property	Why not?
position	Locks the block in a specific spot → not reusable
margin	Placement should depend on context , not the block itself
width, height	May break flexibility on different screens
top, left, right, bottom	Same reason as position — layout shouldn't live inside the block
z-index	Stacking depends on the page, not the component

🎯 Think of a BEM block as a reusable, independent component

Check Binabox design



👤 Tony Nguyen | 📅 20 Jun 2022

Sonic live

One September 22, 2021. Voluptat nulla eros, nulla ultrices nec nulla imperdiet...

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float

allows content to flow around a block element.

The block is pushed to the specified side as far as possible.

float document flow 

```
float: left;  
      : right;  
      : both;  
      : none;
```

Do not use float for building layouts!

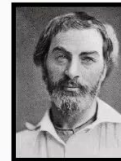


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“This is what you shall do; ~~Love~~ the earth and sun and the animals, despise riches, give alms to every one that asks, stand up for the stupid and crazy, devote your income and labor to others, hate tyrants, argue not concerning God, have patience and indulgence toward the people, take off your hat to nothing known or unknown or to any man or number of men, go freely with powerful uneducated persons and with the young and with the mothers of families, read these leaves in the



Walt Whitman



Photo by Jeremy Bishop on Unsplash

open air every season of every year of your life, re-examine all you have been told at school or church or in any book, dismiss whatever insults your own soul, and your very flesh shall be a great poem and have the richest fluency not only in its words but in the silent lines of its lips and face and between the lashes of your eyes and in every motion and joint of your body.” – Walt Whitman, Song of Myself

clear float

is used to stop elements from being wrapped by floated elements.

It can be applied to:

1. An element that follows a floated element - **float**

clear: left;
: right;
: both;
: none;



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clear float

It can be applied to:

2. An element that contains a floated element

Alternatives:

overflow: `hidden;` 

display: `flow-root;` 



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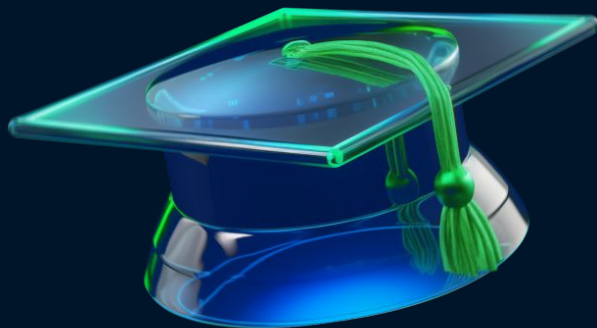
Quality Criteria for HTML Course

❤️ 2.12 Use flex or grid for layouts
Do not use tables or positioning.

- ❤️ Mandatory for passing the course
- 💛 Required for the highest grade
- 💚 Optional

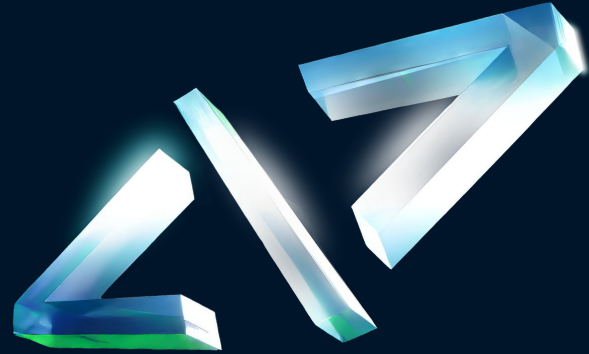
Summary

1. How elements are positioned in the document flow
2. How positioning and stacking context work
3. The purpose of float



Homework

1. Use positioning properties (relative, absolute, fixed, etc.) where necessary, especially for pseudo-elements.





QUESTIONS?

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THANK YOU!

Have a good evening!